# PAST SIMPLE & PRESENT PERFECT

Two ways to talk about the past.

A simple, practical grammar lesson



# What will we learn?

No pressure:we’ll build each sentence one step at a time.

01 • TODAY'S PLAN

01

## Review

Talk aboutafinishedpastaction.

02

## Build

Make a PresentPerfectsentence.

03

## Compare

Notice thedifferencebetweenthe two.

04

## Practice

Complete sentencesandspeak.



GOAL: BUILD SENTENCES

# Let’s start with yesterday

Think of one thing you did yesterday. You can answer in Portuguese first.

QUESTION

## What did you do yesterday?

O que você fez ontem?

**yesterday = ontem**

EXAMPLE ANSWERS

**I studied.**
**I watched TV.**
**I played a game.**

Remember: a short, correct sentence is better than a long, confusing one.

# Past Simple

Use it for an action that started and finished in the past.

THE FORMULA

## Subject + past verb

I played soccer yesterday.
She watched a movie last night.

Eu joguei… / Ela assistiu…

TIME WORDS

**yesterday • last week in 2024 • two days ago**

These tell us WHEN it happened.

**Regular: play → played**
**Irregular: go → went**

# Past Simple or Present Perfect?

Both talk about the past — but they focus on different things.

**PAST SIMPLE**

**I watched that movie yesterday.**

**We know WHEN.**

**PRESENT PERFECT**

**I have watched that movie.**

**The experience matters.**

**Today, we'll focus on experiences: "I have…" / "She has…"**

# Build the sentence

Start with the person, add have/has,thenthe verb form.

| SUBJECT | + HAVE / HAS | + VERB FORM |
| --- | --- | --- |
| I / You / We / They | have / has | seen / eaten / played |

**I have seen that movie.**

Eu já assisti a esse filme.

# Choose the correct auxiliary verb.

Good news: you only need to remember this pattern.

**I • YOU • WE • THEY**

I have played.

**HE • SHE • IT**

She has played.

**HE / SHE / IT → HAS**

# The third form of the verb

Some verbs are regular. Others change — learn them little by little.

| BASE VERB | PAST SIMPLE | VERB FORM WITH HAVE/HAS |
|---|---|---|
| play | played | **played** |
| visit | visited | **visited** |
| go | went | **gone** |
| eat | ate | **eaten** |
| see | saw | **seen** |
| do | did | **done** |

**Tip: after HAVE/HAS, use the third column.**

# Present Perfect in real life

For now, think of experiences — things you have or haven't done.

**I have eaten sushi.**
Eu já comi sushi.

**She has visited London.**
Ela já visitou Londres.

**They have watched this film.**
Eles já assistiram a este filme.

**He has never flown by plane.**
Ele nunca viajou de avião.

**Notice: have/has + eaten / visited / watched / flown**

# Same past, different focus

A simple rule to help you choose.

PAST SIMPLE

## I went to Rio in 2024.

Eu fui ao Rio em 2024.

**Specific time: in 2024**

PRESENT PERFECT

## I have been to Rio.

Eu já fui ao Rio.

**Life experience; no date**

**YESTERDAY / LAST YEAR → usually Past Simple**

# Complete the sentences

Choose the correct option. Work alone first, then compare answers.

1. **1. Yesterday, I ___ soccer.** — played / have played
2. **2. She ___ visited London.** — have / has
3. **3. I have ___ sushi.** — ate / eaten
4. **4. They ___ to school last Monday.** — went / have gone
5. **5. He has never ___ by plane.** — flown / flew

5 QUESTIONS • 4 MIN

# Ask a partner

You can answer with a full sentence — or start with the short answer.

**ASK:**

**Have you ever eaten sushi?**

**Have you ever watched a film in English?**

**Have you ever traveled by plane?**

**ANSWER:**

**Yes, I have.**
**No, I haven’t.**

Yes, I have eaten sushi.

Teacher tip: model one answer first; students can copy the structure.

# Three things to remember

If you remember these, you've made a great start.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Past Simple** | I played yesterday. → finished action + specific time |
| 02 | **Present Perfect** | I have played. → experience / connection to now |
| 03 | **Have or has?** | I/you/we/they HAVE • he/she/it HAS |

**SMALL STEPS. STRONG SENTENCES.**



TEACHER GUIDE

# Your 40-minute lesson

Use this slide asyourprivateplanningguide—skipitduringthepresentationifyouprefer.

| | |
|---|---|
| Warm-up + plan | **5 min** |
| Past Simple review | **5 min** |
| Present Perfect formula + have/has | **12 min** |
| Verb forms + examples | **7 min** |
| Practice + speaking | **8 min** |
| Recap | **3 min** |

If students struggle, spend less time comparing and more time building simple sentences.

# Activity answer key

Use after students have tried the questions.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | played | Past Simple: yesterday |
| 2 | has | She → has |
| 3 | eaten | Past participle of eat |
| 4 | went | Past Simple: last Monday |
| 5 | flown | Past participle of fly |

**Speaking: accept “Yes, I have.” / “No, I haven’t.”**